Swedemom

Share the gains.



A PROPOSAL FOR YOUR FEEDBACK · DRAFT, OCTOBER 2026

How a production bonus could work at Swedemom: your wage never goes down, and every bit of good, efficient work above the bar puts more in your pocket.

Draft for your feedback. Every rule and number may change.

For everyone on the Swedemom team

THE SHORT VERSION

The one-page summary.

Short on time? This page covers the whole idea. The rest has the details.

1 **Your wage never goes down.**
Everything here is extra, on top of your hourly pay.

2 **Clear your bar, keep half.**
Each item earns the minutes its category normally takes. The bar sits just below what our fastest people already do. Above it, you keep half of the time you save, paid at your wage, with no set limit.

3 **Hit the team goal, everyone earns.**
If your stage hits its weekly goal, everyone in it gets **+$0.50 for every hour worked**. Beat it by 10% and it's **+$1.00 an hour**.

4 **Only good work counts.**
Items sent back for fixes count once they're right. Mistakes can lower a bonus, never your wage.

5 **Better tools come first.**
Equipped stations, instant feedback, clock-in and a one-tap timer, and live progress in the Hub, before anything is paid.

JOHN DOE, A MADE-UP IMAGER AT $16/HR, 30 HOURS A WEEK

$480	$504	$519	$558
Today	Clears his bar	+ team goal	A great week, +16%

Nothing changes yet. First, an anonymous 8 to 10 minute survey. Then practice mode, where you see what you *would* earn, then a two-week paid pilot, then we decide together. Every number here is a draft.

CONTENTS

Read what applies to you.

Everyone should read the first part: how the bonus works for the whole team. Then jump to the page for the work you do. Tap any line to go there.

01	Why we're doing this	4
02	Two ways to earn more	5
03	Every item is worth minutes	6
04	Clear the bar, keep half	7
05	A week, worked out	8
06	A day, minute by minute	9
07	Only good work counts	10
08	Team goals for each stage	11
09	How the bar rises	12
10	Hours, breaks and payday	13
11	What we're building first	14
12	What happens next	20
13	Questions you might have	21

Your stage

Sorting
page 15

Intake + description
page 16

Imaging
page 17

Put-away
page 18

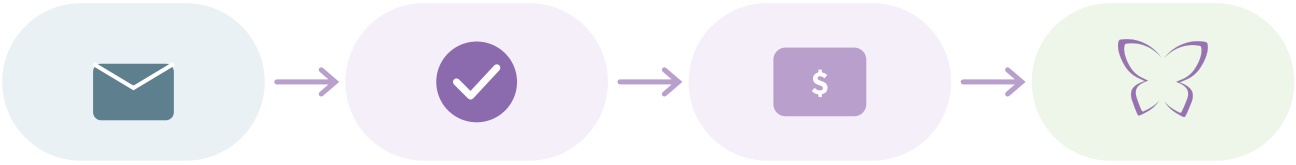
Fulfillment
page 19

Swedemom's future runs through production.

For months we've been asking everyone to produce more, and more efficiently, because Swedemom only becomes self-sustaining if turning donations into listings gets faster without getting worse. How much good work we finish each hour decides how far the mission goes. Now we want that extra effort to pay you too.

Work efficiently, earn more. Everyone wins.

When you work efficiently and well, you save Swedemom real money, and you should share in it, the way salespeople earn commission. You take home more, more items get listed, and the mission grows. That's the idea behind this production bonus, and we want to build it with you, not hand it to you.



Donations arrive → You make them ready → They sell → The mission grows

What we promise from the start

Your wage never goes down

Bonuses only add. No penalties on pay, no clawbacks.

Everyone can win

No curve and no ranking. You're measured against the bar, not each other.

A bar that rises only with proof

It goes up when better tools are proven to save time, never because you worked harder.

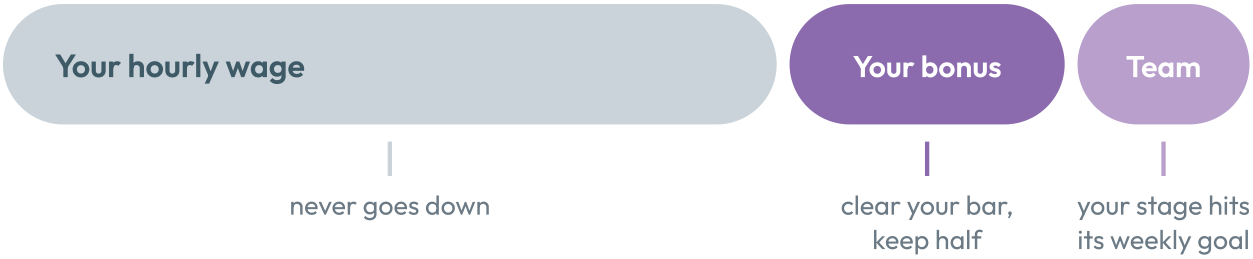
You help shape it

An anonymous survey first, then a practice run where nothing is paid.

Two ways to earn more.

Your paycheck would have up to three parts. The first never changes. The other two are new, and they're pure upside: more earning potential for everyone.

ONE PAYCHECK



1 · YOUR BONUS

Clear the bar, keep half.

Each item you finish earns "minutes" based on how long that kind of item normally takes. Earn more minutes than you worked, and you've saved Swedemom time.

You keep half of the time you save, paid at your wage. There's no set limit on how much you can earn.

2 · TEAM BONUS

Hit the goal together.

Each stage has a weekly goal. If your stage hits it, **everyone in it earns +$0.50 for every hour worked** that week.

Beat it by 10% and it doubles to **+$1.00 an hour**.

Only good work counts. Items sent back for fixes don't earn anything until they're right. The bonus is about doing more *good* work, not just more work (page 10).

Every item is worth minutes.

A paperback is quicker to image than a lamp. So instead of counting items, each item earns the minutes it normally takes at that stage. Each item earns its category's average time, so quick and slow items even out and there's no reason to hunt for easy ones.



Example imaging values, for illustration only. Real values come from Swedemom's own data and stay fixed once set.

Your pace

Add up the minutes your items earned and compare them with the minutes you worked on production.

minutes earned ÷ minutes worked

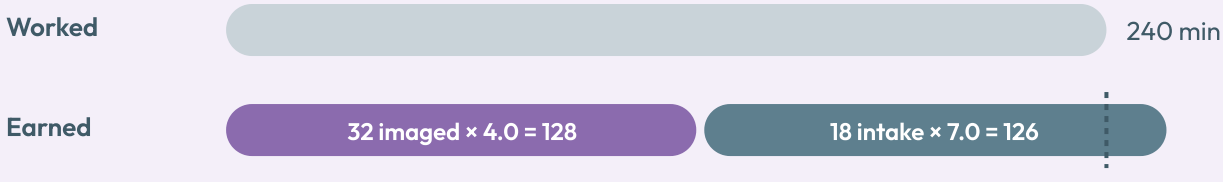
= your pace

Different jobs, one score

An imaged item earns imaging minutes; an intake item earns intake minutes. If you help in several stages, it all adds up into one score, so jumping in where you're needed never costs you.

Breaks and other work (truck runs, wrapping glass, meetings) are paid and don't count against you (page 13).

EXAMPLE: JOHN DOE HELPS IN TWO STAGES

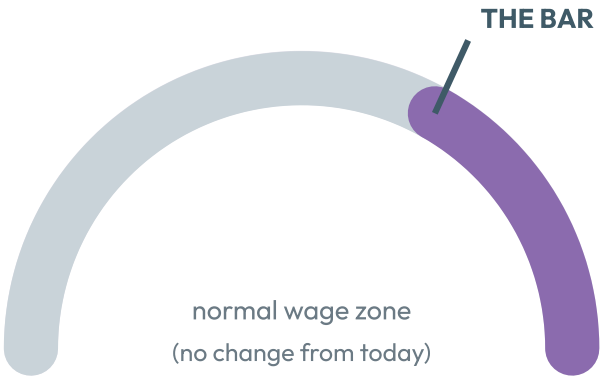


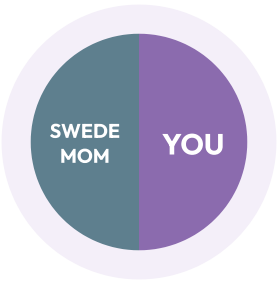
254 earned in 240 worked: **14 minutes saved**, about **$1.87** for John at $16/hr.

John Doe is a made-up team member used in every example in this guide.

Clear the bar, keep half.

The bar is set just below what our fastest people already do. Average work earns your normal wage, exactly like now. Above the bar, every minute you save is split: half to you, half to Swedemom. The faster you go while staying right, the more you earn, in a straight line.





every minute saved, split down the middle

IMAGING BAR

~15 items / hr

for an average item (about 4 minutes each)

INTAKE + DESCRIPTION

~8.6 items / hr

for an average item (about 7 minutes each)

WHAT A MINUTE IS WORTH

13¢

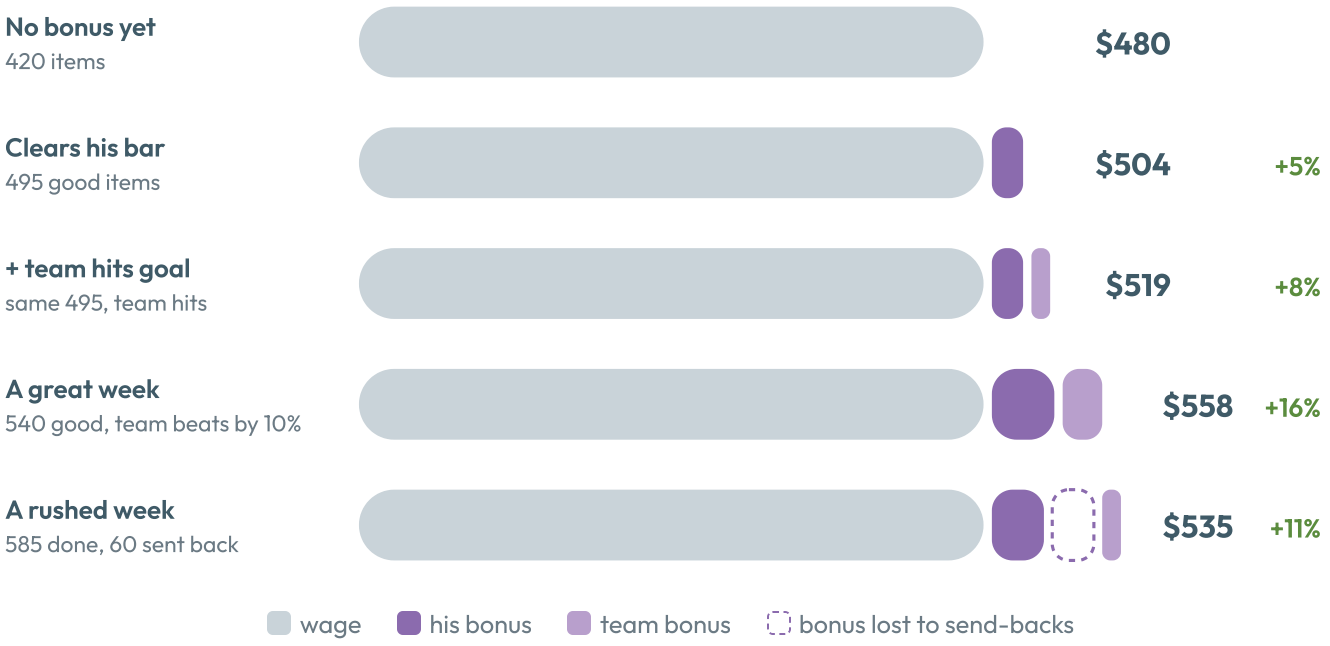
your half of each minute saved, at $16/hr. One extra average imaged item is about 53¢.

These bars are today's estimates. They come from Hub timestamps, not payroll hours. Before anyone is paid, we reset them on real clocked hours and share the final numbers. Other stages get their bars the same way.

Push as far as you can. There's no set limit on the bonus. Very big weeks just get a quick check that the data is right before payout. We start at half, and if the pilot shows that isn't motivating enough, the share goes up.

Five possible weeks for John.

John Doe images. He earns $16 an hour and works 30 hours a week, so $480. His bar is 450 average items for the week.



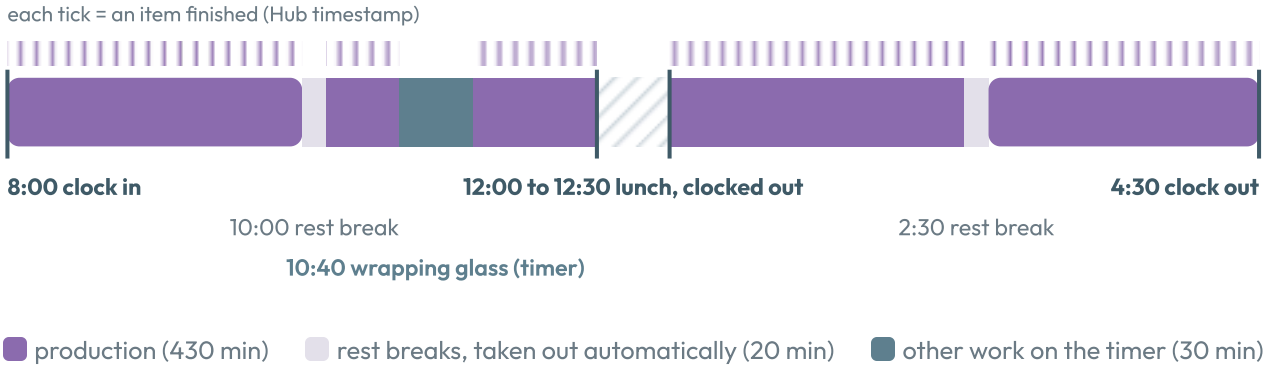
THE MATH, CLEAR-THE-BAR WEEK	AMOUNT
495 good items × 4 min earned, against 1,800 minutes worked	180 min saved
180 minutes = 3 hours of labor at $16/hr	$48 saved
John keeps half	**+$24**
His stage hits its team goal: 30 hours × $0.50	**+$15**

The rushed week. John finished 585 items, but 60 came back for re-imaging, so only 525 count. He still makes $535, but the send-backs cost him $32 he'd have earned if the work had been right. Steady, consistent work pays best. His wage never moved.

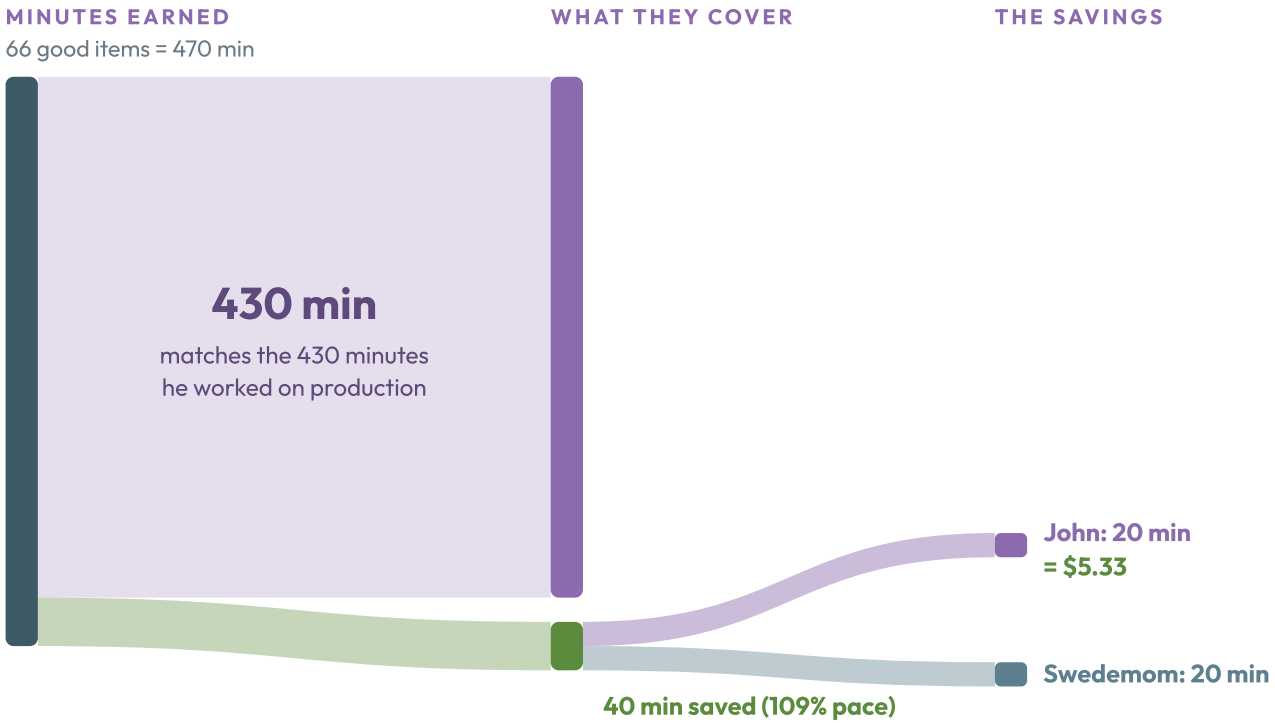
One day of intake, start to finish.

Here's how a whole day turns into a bonus. John Doe (made up) does intake + description from 8:00 to 4:30, with a 30-minute unpaid lunch.

1. His day in the Hub



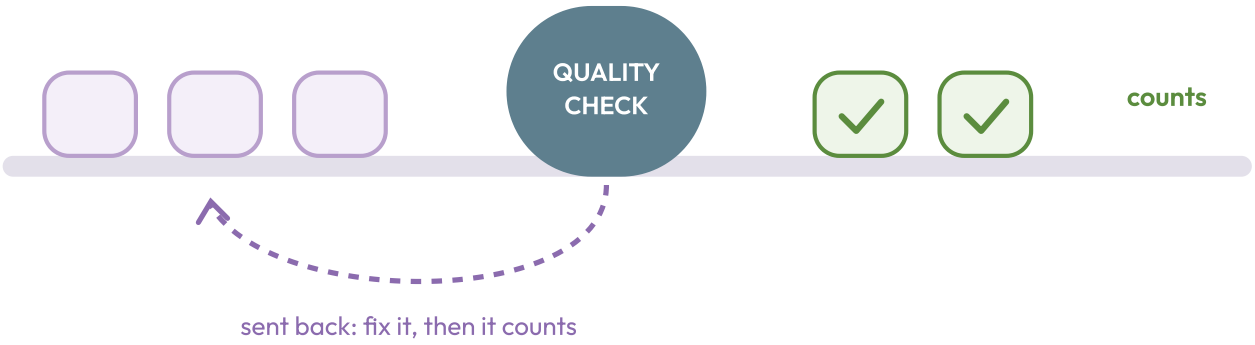
2. Where his minutes go



Paid time 480 min (8:00 to 12:00 and 12:30 to 4:30). Minus 20 min of rest breaks and 30 min wrapping glass leaves **430 production minutes**. His items earned 470, so he saved 40 and keeps half: **$5.33 on top of his $128 wage** that day.

Only good work counts.

Programs that pay for "more" can backfire if quality slips. Ours only counts items that pass. A send-back lowers that week's bonus, never your wage, and the item comes back to you quickly so you can fix it and learn from it.



Every item is weighted fairly

Each item earns its category's average time, so quick items and slow items even out. There's no reason to pick and choose: take the next item and get it right the first time.

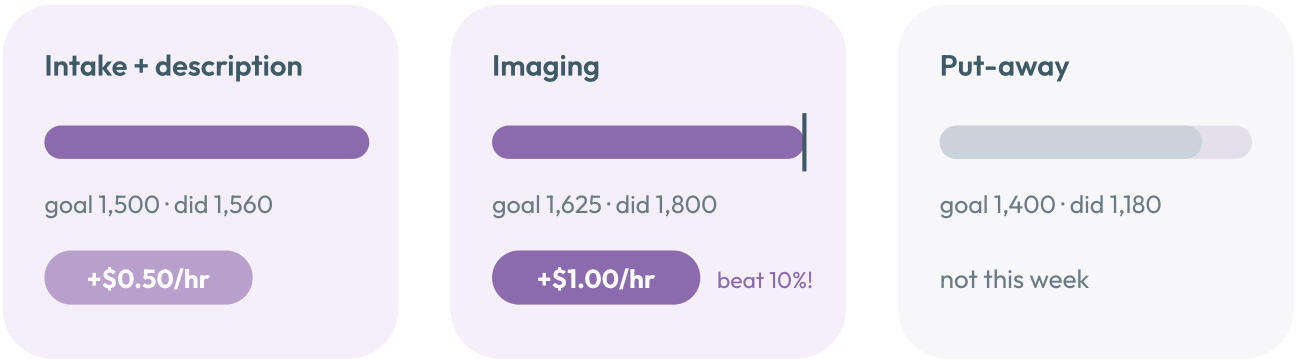
Feedback that comes fast

We're building instant checks so problems are caught while the item is still in front of you, not days later (page 14). Your stage page shows what "good" means for your work.

Disagree with a send-back? Dispute it in a tap in the Hub. A lead for your area reviews it, and a mistaken one is reversed before bonuses are paid.

Each stage, one weekly goal.

Managers set a weekly goal for each stage before the week starts. When a stage hits it, everyone who worked in it shares the reward, so helping a teammate pays too.



Example numbers only. Sorting and fulfillment have goals too.

Work in more than one stage?

Your team bonus follows your work. If 60% of your minutes this week came from imaging and 40% from intake, 60% of your team bonus follows imaging's result and 40% follows intake's.

60% imaging | 40% intake

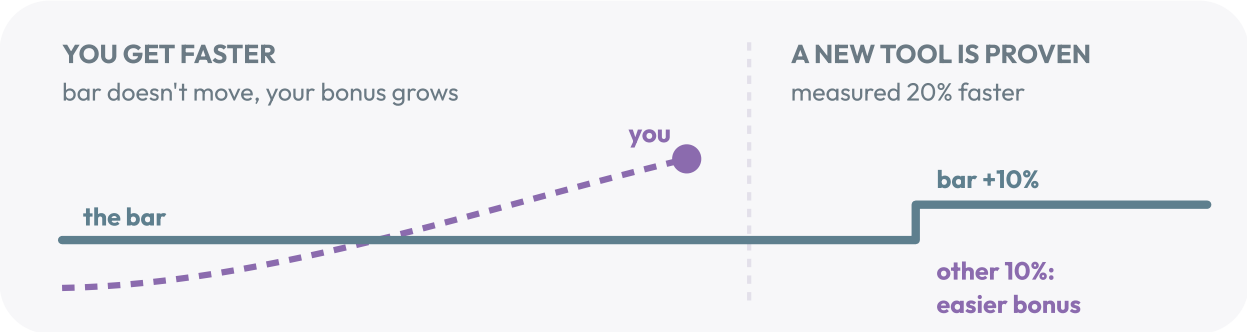
Worked out automatically. Nothing to log.

How goals work

- Set before the week starts, the way weekly goals are set today.
- Counted in good items, so you can follow them during the week.
- Volunteer items count toward the goals. Volunteers don't earn bonuses.

The bar rises only with proof.

The bar will go up over time. That's how Swedemom grows. But it only goes up for a proven reason, like a new tool that makes the work faster. It never rises just because you got faster. Studies of that trap found output 20 to 40% lower, so the rules are written down before we start.



PROVEN

Only after a measured change

The bar moves only when a new tool or process is measured before and after, on our own floor.

SHARED

By half the gain

If a tool makes the work 20% faster, the bar rises 10%. The other half is easier bonus for you.

ANNOUNCED

Two weeks ahead

Posted two weeks in advance, at most twice a quarter, with the before-and-after numbers.

What you'll see. Just like Production Metrics today: your own numbers, your stage's totals and the team averages. No public leaderboard.

Simple to track, clear on your paycheck.

Your hours

- **Clock in and out** like you do now. We're testing clocking in right in the Hub, so everything lives in one place.
- **Rest breaks come out automatically.** Nothing to log, and they never hurt your pace. Take them.
- **Other work goes on a one-tap timer.** Truck runs, wrapping glass, meetings, training, equipment that's down: paid as always, and left out of your pace.
- **Bonus minutes start at your scheduled start time.** Attendance itself stays a normal conversation with your manager, not a bonus penalty.
- Managers look over the time log weekly. Normal ups and downs are fine. It's reviewed, not policed.

Your paycheck

PAY STUB (EXAMPLE)

Regular hours	$480.00
Production bonus	$24.00
Team bonus	$15.00
Gross	**$519.00**

- Bonuses appear as their own lines on your normal paycheck.
- The Hub shows the math behind them: items, minutes, the bar and the result.



Bonuses are paid one paycheck later. That gives send-backs, reviews and disputes time to finish, so the number you get is right the first time. A problem found later, like an item in the wrong bin, counts in the week it's found, the way a store counts a return in the month it comes back. It lowers that week's bonus, never your wage or a bonus already paid. If you leave Swedemom, any bonus you've earned is paid in your final check.

Better tools come before any bonus.

A bonus is only fair with the right tools, the right numbers, and feedback while it still helps. So before anything is paid, we're equipping stations and improving the Hub.

A ready-to-go station

A dedicated phone camera (never your own phone), a fast computer, scanner, label printer and scale, plus built-in Hub tutorials.

Instant feedback

Photos are checked as they upload, and Final Check flags problems sooner. Packers see photos of any damage.

Fixes go to the right person

Re-imaging is traced to whoever imaged the item first, and credit follows whoever fixes it. Disputes go to a lead in a tap.

Clock-in and a one-tap timer

Hours, breaks and other work in one place, so your pace counts only production time.

Live progress

Your minutes, your pace and your stage's goal, during the day, right in the Hub.

Better Production Metrics

Real clocked hours, no work dropped, sorting included, and detailed Hub data to find the slow steps.

A faster Sort tool

Quicker to use, and it's how sorting gets credited (page 15).

A statement every payday

Exactly how your bonus was worked out, item by item.

Got an idea? The survey asks what slows you down most. The answers will shape what we build next.

Sorting decides what's worth it.



Sorters choose what goes into production, so sorting is credited on the **value** of what you send in, not just how much you handle.

Why we're asking everyone to sort in the Sort tool

We know: eyeballing a box can feel faster than scanning it. But what you decide at sorting shapes everything after it, and the Sort tool is the only way that decision gets recorded.

- **It's how sorting gets credited.** Work done outside the tool can't count toward your bonus or your team's goal.
- **It sends the right things to eBay.** Price estimates help route each item to where it earns the most.
- **It teaches us what sells.** Every scan improves pricing and shows which donations are worth the most.
- **We'll keep making it faster.** Tell us what slows you down in it.

What earns credit

The estimated value of items you send into production through the Sort tool, using the system's estimate.

What counts as good

Items that move forward. Things rejected later at intake don't count, so send in what's worth listing.

Your team goal

A weekly goal for items sorted into production through the Sort tool, set by managers.

Intake + description.



Every item you intake and describe earns its standard minutes. The bar starts around 8.6 average items an hour (about 7 minutes each) and is reset on real hours before pay.

What earns minutes

Each item, by category. Harder categories (jewelry lots, coins, detailed collectibles) earn more minutes than quick ones.

What counts as good

Items that pass Final Check: right details, measurements and condition. Flagged items count once they're fixed.

Your team goal

Items intaken and described in the week, set by managers before the week starts.

Take the next item

Every category is weighted by its average time, so no kind of item is a better deal than another. Take what's next and get its details right the first time, so it doesn't come back to you.

See it worked out. The full-day example on page 9 follows an intake day from clock-in to bonus.

Imaging.



Every item you image earns its standard minutes. The bar starts around 15 average items an hour (about 4 minutes each) and is reset on real hours before pay.

What earns minutes

Each item, by category. A paperback earns less than a lamp or a piece of glassware that needs careful shots.

What counts as good

Images that pass the quality check. Items sent back for re-imaging count once they're redone.

Your team goal

Items imaged in the week, set by managers before the week starts.

Feedback while the item is in front of you

We're building a check that runs as photos upload, so problems are caught right away instead of days later. Re-imaging comes back to whoever imaged the item first, so you get the chance to fix your own work.

See it worked out. John Doe's five example weeks on page 8 are an imager's weeks.

Put-away.



An item can't go live without a bin, so put-away is what turns finished work into listings. Shelving earns minutes like any other stage.

What earns minutes

Each item shelved, with its standard minutes.

What counts as good

The item is in the bin the Hub says it's in, so it can be found and shipped when it sells. An item later found in the wrong bin counts in the week it's found.

Your team goal

Items put away in the week, sized to the people we have on put-away.

More hands on put-away

Put-away depends on very few people today. We'll train more people on it, and anyone who helps shelve earns put-away minutes, so jumping in when carts pile up pays.

Why it matters to everyone. Finished items waiting on a cart can't sell. Same-day put-away is one of the fastest ways to grow sales.

Fulfillment.



Orders earn minutes just like items do, by type of order. Pack orders well and quickly, and the time you free up for production earns minutes too.

What earns minutes

Each order, by type: a single small item, several items, or a large or fragile piece.

What counts as good

Orders that arrive safely, correct and on time. Damage is reviewed with photos. Carrier damage doesn't count against you, only packing mistakes, in the week the case is settled.

Your team goal

Every order shipped on time and right, every day of the week.

Think an item won't survive shipping? Flag it as a fragile risk in a tap before it ships. A lead decides what to do, and it can't count against you.

Finish strong, then help produce

Order volume depends on what sells, so fulfillment is measured on how well and how efficiently orders go out. Wrap up the day's orders, then jump into production: those minutes count toward the same score.

Other important work, like checking that items are in the right bin and clearing out stale inventory, isn't part of the bonus yet. Tell us in the survey how you'd reward it.

We try it before we commit.

Nobody gets paid on a plan they haven't seen work. Here are the steps, in order. Dates after the survey are set once the Hub tools are ready.

1. **Tell us what you think**

   ONE WEEK An anonymous survey, about 8 to 10 minutes. Only totals are shared.

2. **We share what we heard**

   The survey results and the updated plan, including anything you changed.

3. **We build the tools**

   Everything on page 14: stations, feedback, clock-in, timer, live progress, metrics.

4. **Practice mode: two weeks, nothing paid**

   You see your minutes and what you *would* have earned, so we can check the numbers feel fair before money is involved.

5. **Paid pilot: two weeks**

   Real bonuses for every stage in this guide: sorting, intake + description, imaging, put-away and fulfillment, plus the team goals.

6. **Decide together**

   Keep it, change it or stop it, based on what the pilot shows and what you tell us.

This is a draft.

Every rule and number in this guide is a starting estimate. We'll adjust them with your feedback, real clocked hours and what practice mode shows before anything is paid.

Frequently asked.

Are these numbers final?

No. This is a draft to get your feedback. Every rule and number will be adjusted with real data before anyone is paid.

Could my pay ever go down?

No. Your hourly wage never changes because of this program. Bonuses only add.

Is this a competition with my coworkers?

No. Everyone is measured against the bar, not each other.

I'm below the bar. What changes for me?

Your pay stays exactly what it is today, and you can still earn the team bonus. And you can get there: ask a teammate or your lead what works for them, and use the newest tools, like camera intake, which are built to make your work faster.

Is there a limit to what I can earn?

No set limit. Unusually big weeks get a quick check that the data is right before payout.

But aren't some items faster to produce?

Yes, so each item earns its category's average time. Quick items earn fewer minutes and slow ones earn more, so they even out. Just take the next item and get it right.

I do more than one job. How does that work?

Minutes from every stage add up into one score (page 6), and your team bonus follows your mix of work (page 11).

What if equipment breaks or the Hub is down?

If equipment breaks, tap the timer: it's paid and doesn't count against your pace. If the Hub is down, we'll have backup plans.

Will the bar go up?

Yes, over time, but only after a new tool or process is proven to save time, by half the gain, with two weeks' notice, at most twice a quarter.

Who sees my numbers?

Most people see only their own numbers, plus team totals and averages, like today. Managers can see everyone's individual and team numbers.

Why is the bonus a paycheck later?

So reviews and disputes are finished and your number is right the first time. Problems found later count in the week they're found.

What about volunteers?

Volunteer items count toward team goals. Volunteers themselves don't earn bonuses.

Who can I talk to?

Your manager, anytime. Or put it in the survey, where it's anonymous.



Tell us what you think.

The survey is anonymous, takes about 8 to 10 minutes, and is open for one week from the day you get this email. What you say shapes the plan, from where the bar sits to how team goals work.

SURVEY LINK

In the email with this proposal

Thank you for everything you do. Every item you touch helps change the world by redeeming people, places, & things.

Swedemom